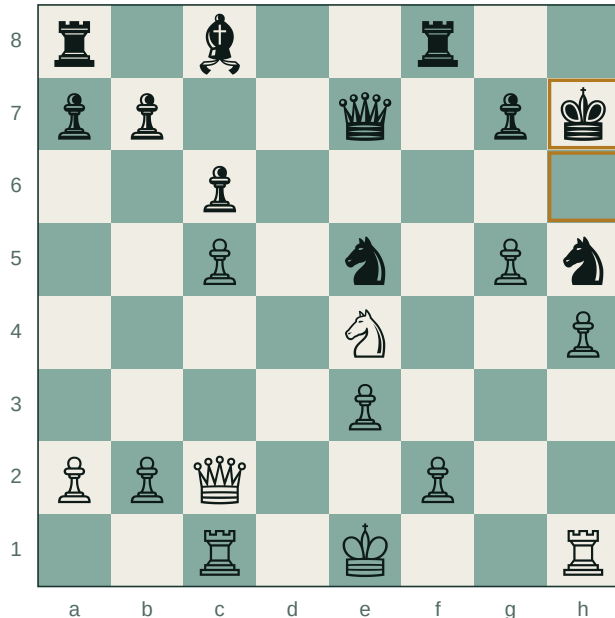


# Double checks: White, move 20

Double checks

White to move



Previous move: 19...Kh7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**20. Nf6+ Kh8 21. Qh7#**

**20.Nf6+** Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From f6 it attacks king on h7 and knight on h5. Recorded reply: **20...Kh8**.

**21.Qh7#** Mate: queen on h7 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

**CHECKPOINT**

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on h7. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on h7. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8 and queen on e7. Check for tactical protection.